Experiment – 12

Approval Process

Creating an Approval Process in Zoho Creator

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Application Name: Purchase Request / Procurement Application

Objective

To configure an approval process in Zoho Creator so that each new Purchase Request is sent to an approver for review, and to define what happens when the request is approved or rejected.

Introduction

An approval process requires a record to be reviewed by a designated approver before it proceeds. When a new record is added to the selected form, the approver can approve or reject it. Actions may be attached to the start of the process or to the approval outcomes, including sending an email, updating fields, adding records to another form, or running a Deluge script. This allows the request to progress based on the approver's decision.

Approval Process Components

Component	Description	Use in this Experiment
Form	The form whose records require review	Purchase Request
Approver	Person or role responsible for reviewing the record	Level 1 Approver: tony441007
Approval and Denial labels	Names displayed on the decision buttons	Approve and Reject
Actions on start	Actions performed when the process begins	None added
Actions on approval or rejection	Actions performed after the decision	Email the submitter and update the record on approval

Table 12.1: Components of the Zoho Creator approval process.

Approval Process Configuration

Setting	Value
Workflow name	HOD Approval
Form	Purchase Request
Run this process	Always
Approver type	User
Approver	tony441007
Approval label	Approve
Denial label	Reject

Table 12.2: Main settings used for the approval process.

Record Update on Approval

Form	Criteria	Field	New Value
Purchase Request	Current record	Approval Status	Pending Finance Approval
Purchase Request	Current record	Hod_Decision	Approve

Table 12.3: Fields updated when the HOD approves a record.

Screenshot-Based Lab Record

The following screenshots illustrate the approval process configuration in Zoho Creator.

Screenshot 1 – Approvals Tab

The Approvals tab under Workflow initially has no approval process configured. The Create Workflow option starts a new approval setup.

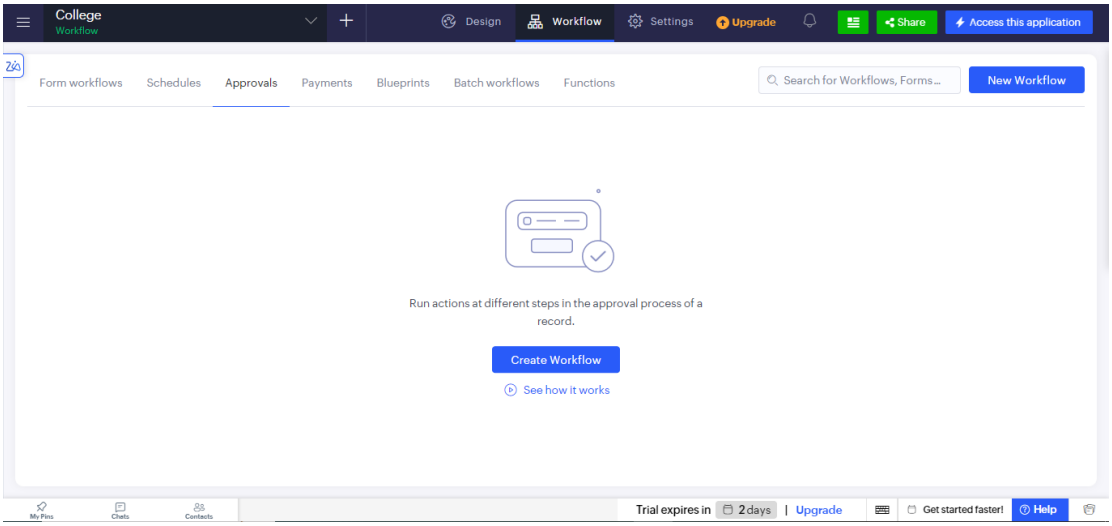


Figure 1: Approvals tab before an approval process is created.

Screenshot 2 – Creating the Approval Process

The setup page asks for a form, a workflow name, and whether the process should run always or only when a condition is met. Purchase Request was selected, the process was named HOD Approval, and Always was chosen.

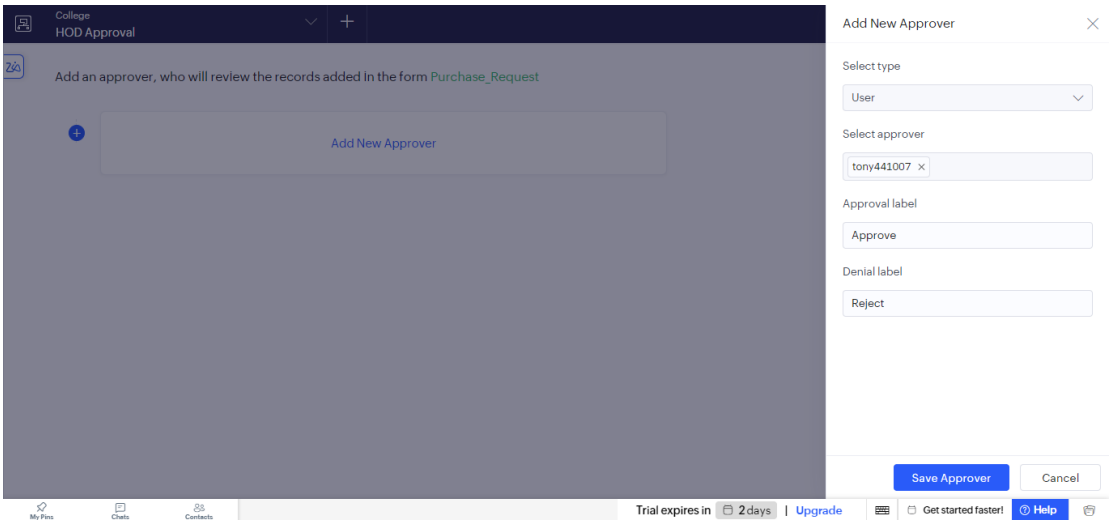


Figure 2: Approval process setup for the Purchase Request form.

Screenshot 3 – Adding the Approver

In the Add New Approver panel, the approver type is User, the selected approver is tony441007, and the decision buttons are labelled Approve and Reject.

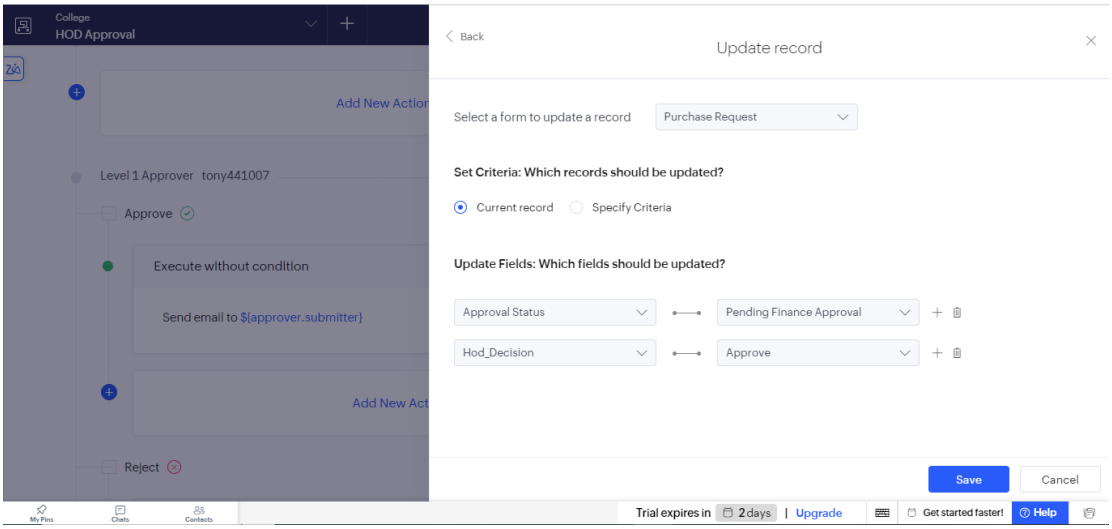


Figure 3: Approver settings and decision labels.

Screenshot 4 – Approval Events and Actions

The process page lists On Start and Level 1 Approver events. An email action can be configured under Approve to notify the submitter, and additional actions can be added if needed.

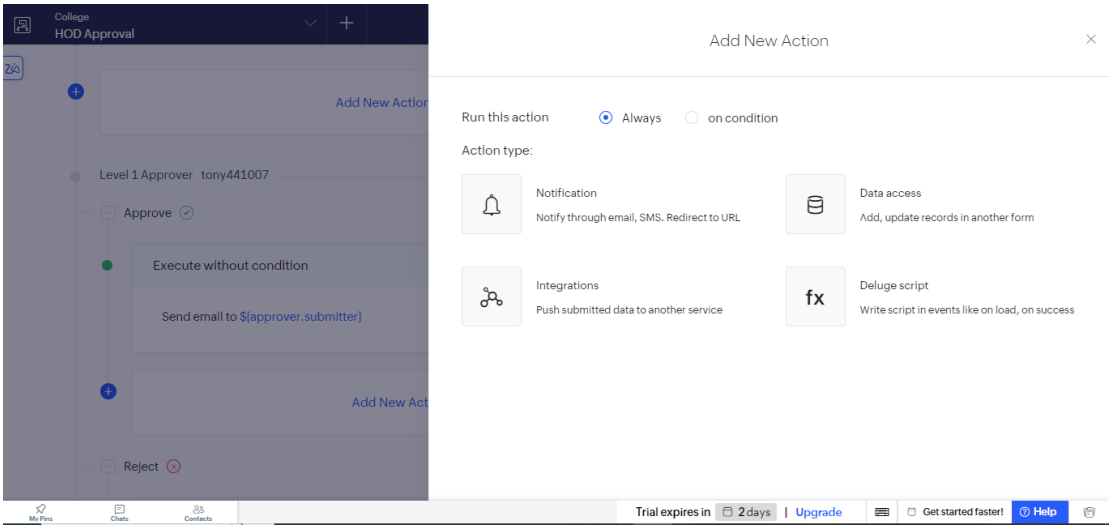


Figure 4: Approval events and the actions attached to the Approve outcome.

Screenshot 5 – Available Action Types

Add New Action offers Notification, Data access, Integrations, and Deluge script. The action can be configured to run always or only when a condition is satisfied.

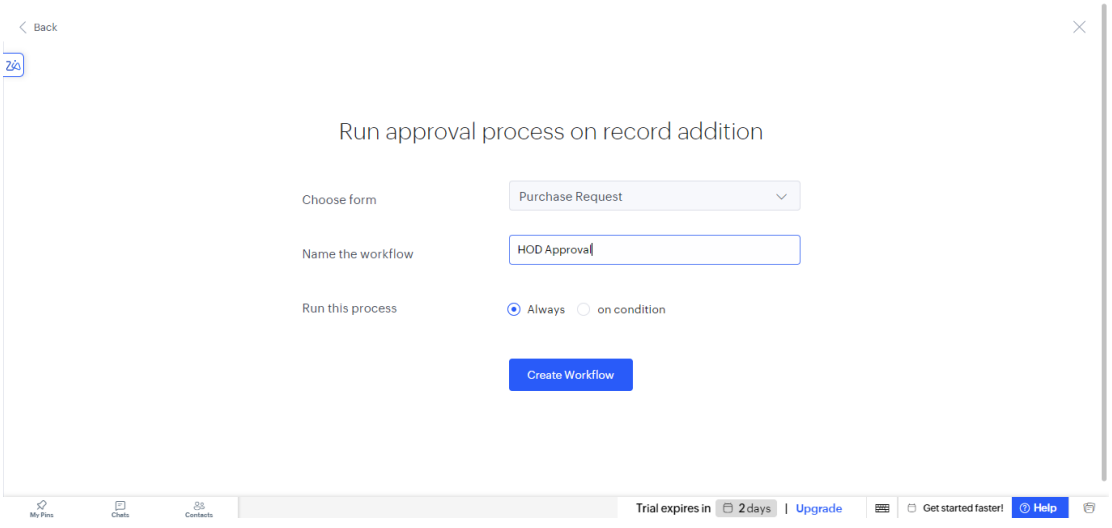


Figure 5: Action types available in the approval process.

Screenshot 6 – Update Record Action

A Data access action updates the current Purchase Request record after approval. Approval Status is set to Pending Finance Approval and Hod_Decision is set to Approve.

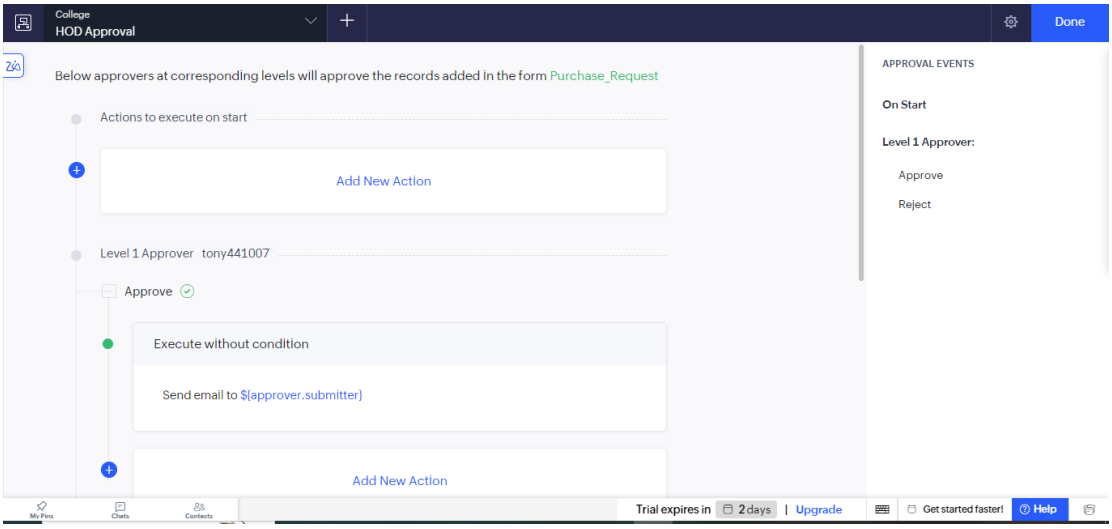


Figure 6: Update record action for the approval outcome.

Observation

The approval process was configured without writing code. Each new Purchase Request is routed to the HOD, who can choose Approve or Reject. When approved, the submitter receives an email and the record is updated to show that it is waiting for Finance approval. Additional approval levels can be added if the request needs review by multiple people. Unlike a Blueprint, which guides a record through stages, an approval process waits for a named approver's decision to determine what happens next.

Result

An approval process named HOD Approval was configured for the Purchase Request form. The user tony441007 was set as the Level 1 approver with Approve and Reject outcomes. On approval, an email is sent to the submitter and the record is updated to Pending Finance Approval with Hod_Decision set to Approve.